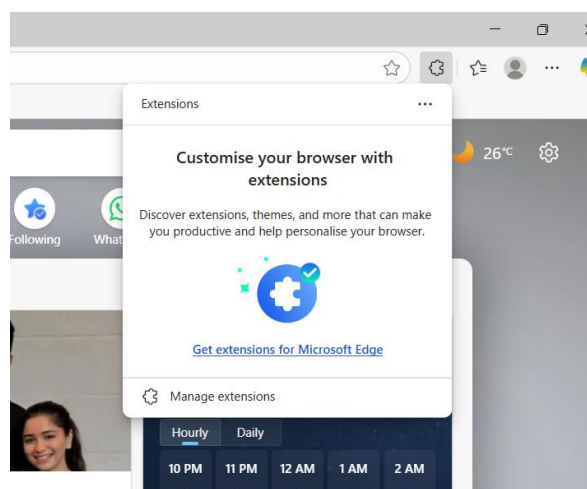
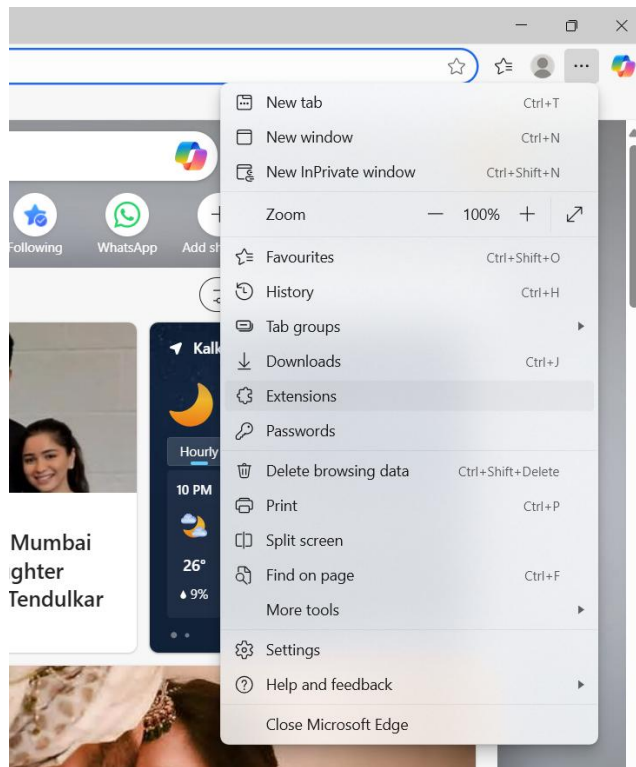
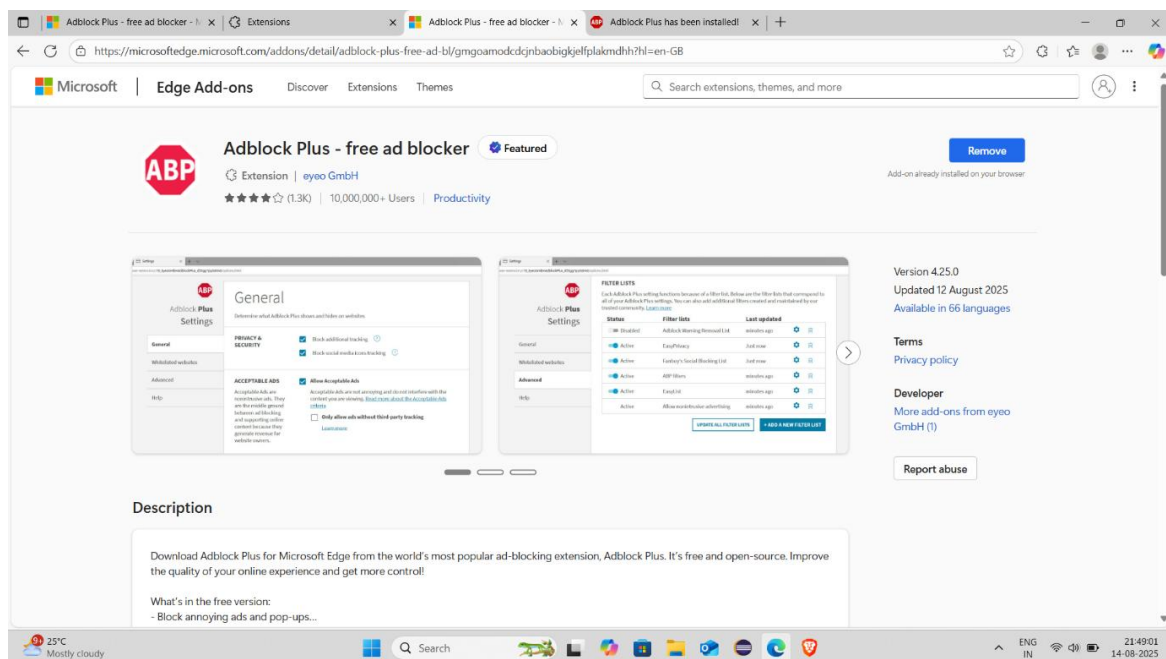
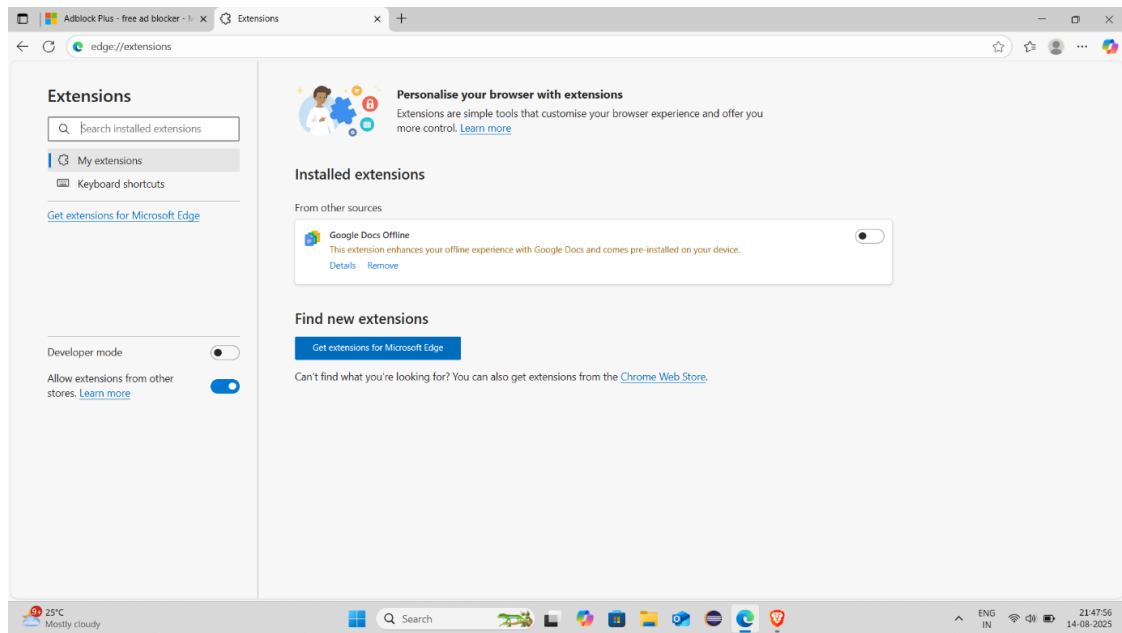


Task 7 :Identify and Remove Suspicious Browser Extensions

1) Microsoft Edge: Menu (⋮) → Extensions → Manage extensions
Or type edge://extensions.



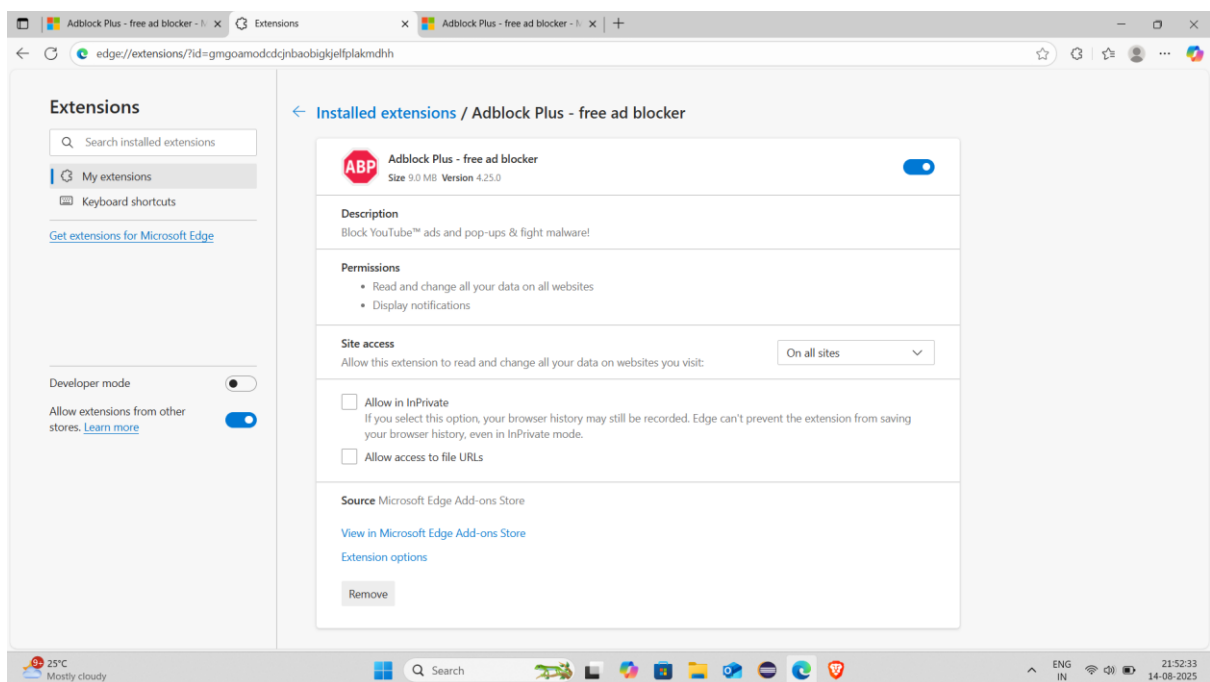
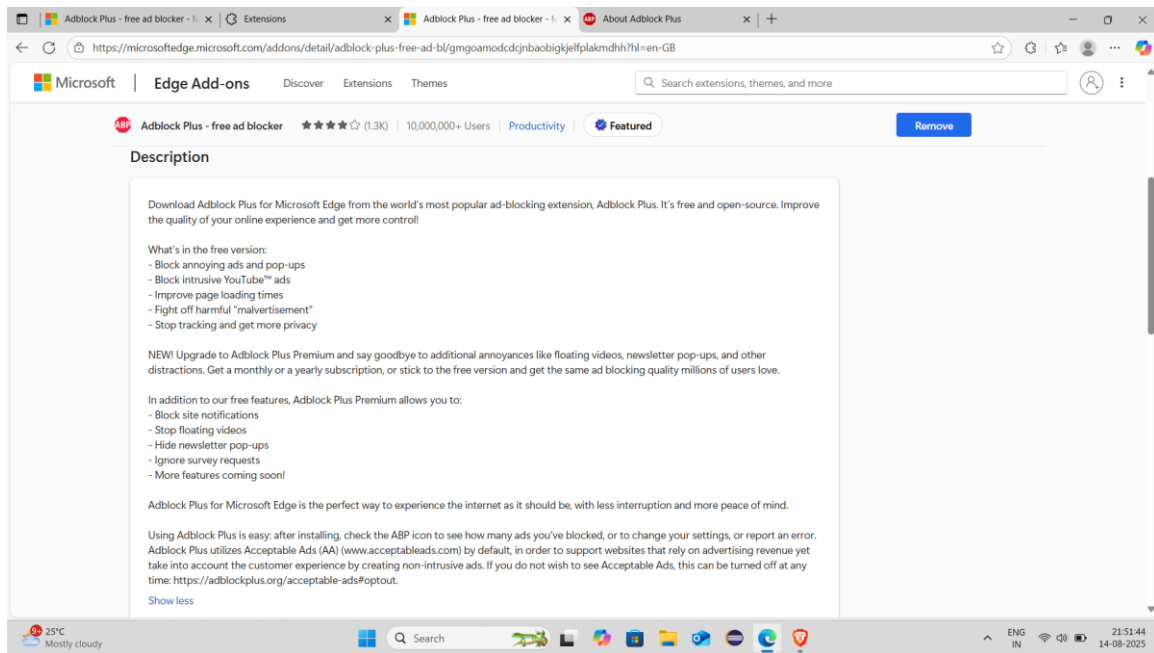


2) Review all installed extensions carefully

For each extension, click **Details** (or its card) and check:

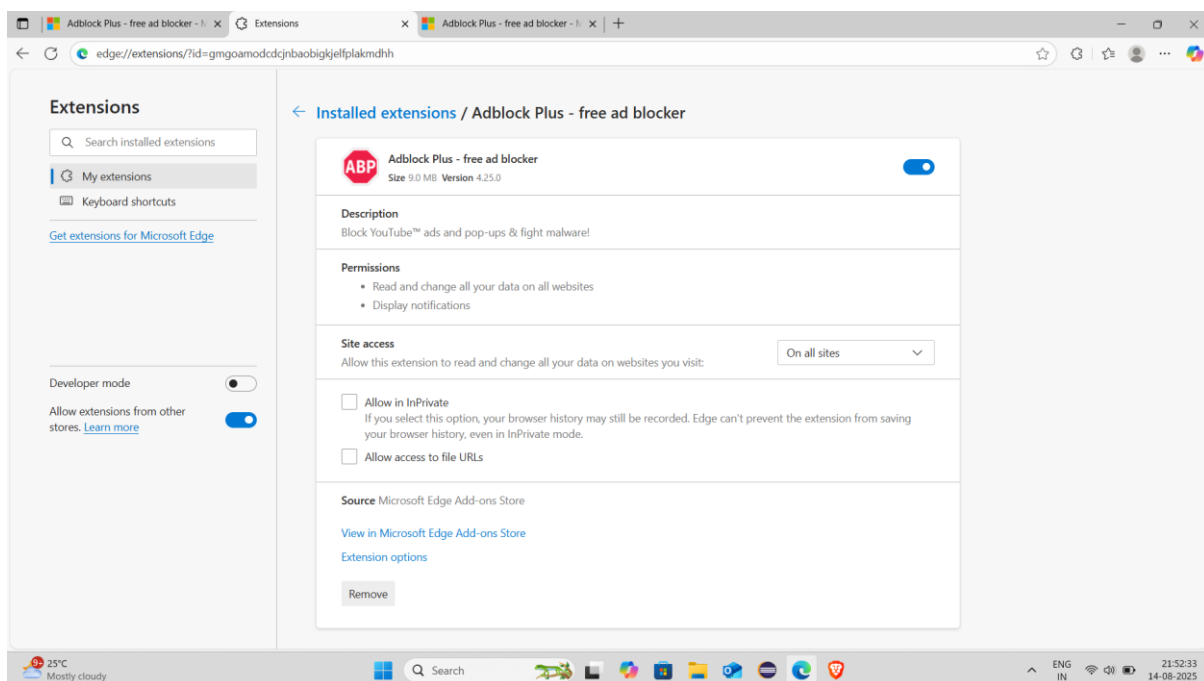
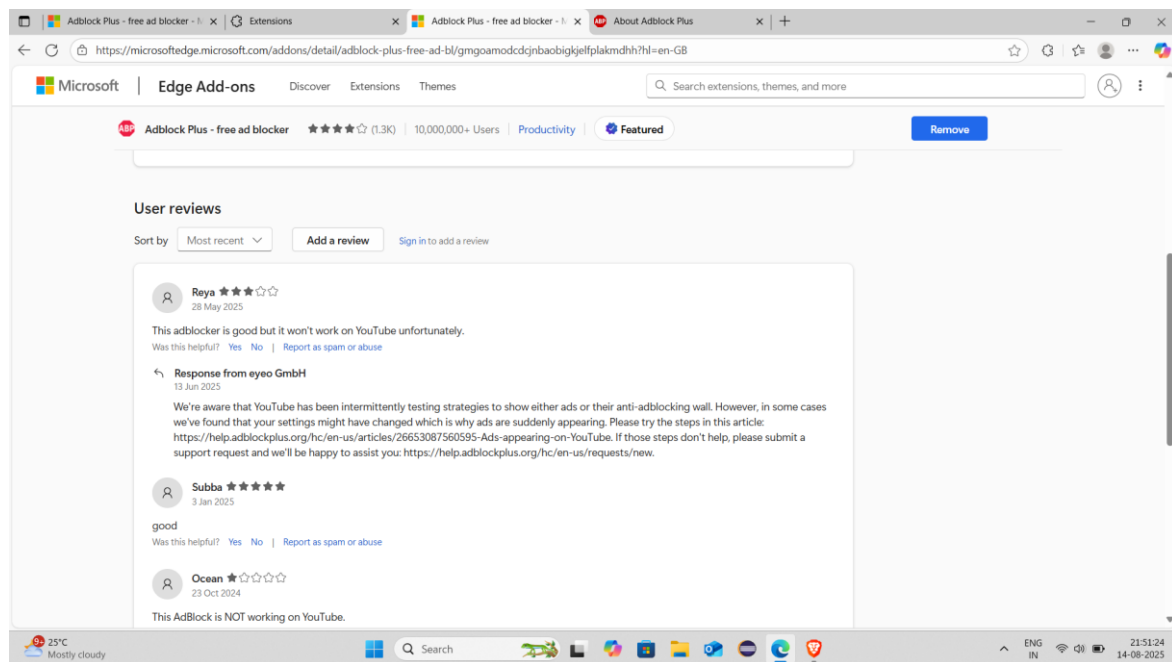
- **What it does** (description, homepage).
- **Last updated** date and **version**. Old/abandoned items are riskier.
- **Permissions** (examples of risky/over-broad ones below).
- **Site access** (“On all sites” vs “On click”).
- **Allow in Incognito/Private** (should usually be **off**).

Red flags:



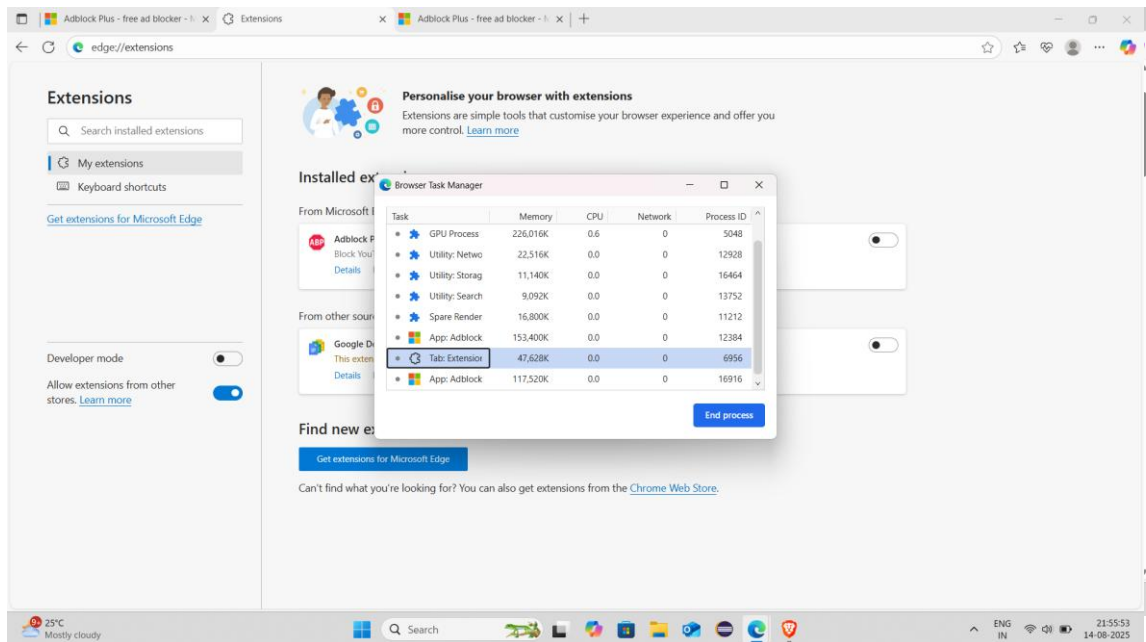
- Vague description or no official store listing.
- Permissions like **“Read and change all your data on all websites”**, **“Manage your downloads”**, **“Read your browsing history”**, **“Communicate with cooperating native applications”** (native messaging) without a clear need.
- Recently renamed/clone look-alikes of popular extensions.
- Poor ratings/reviews, few users, or many reports of ads/redirects.

3) Check permissions and public feedback



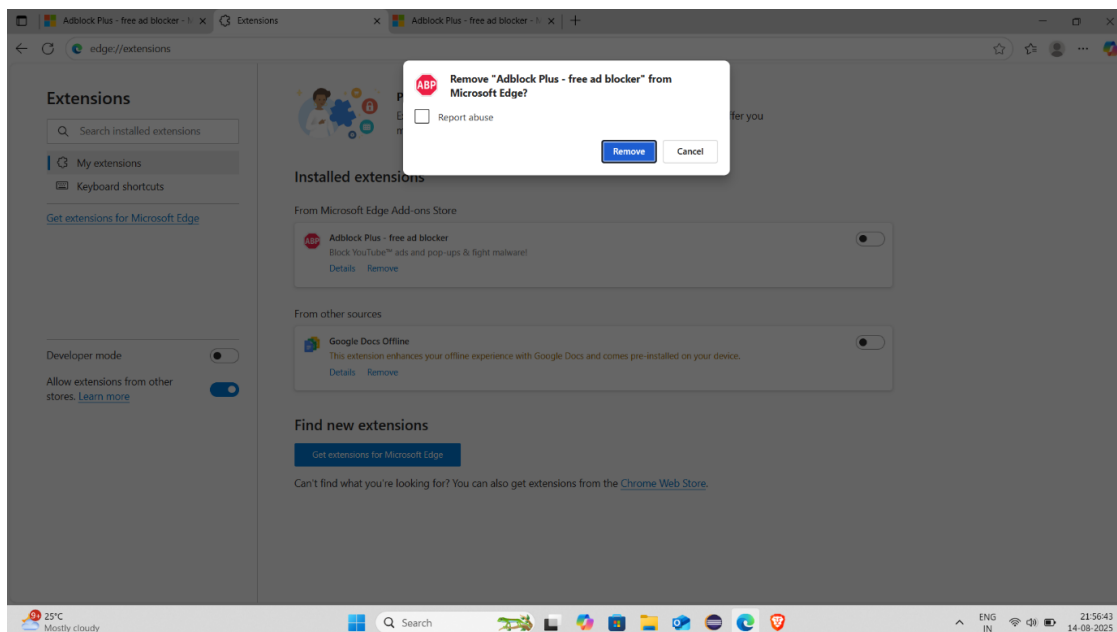
- Open the extension's **store page** from the Details screen; scan **ratings, recent reviews, developer website, and privacy policy**.
- If there's **no store page** (sideloaded), be extra cautious.

4) Identify unused or suspicious extensions

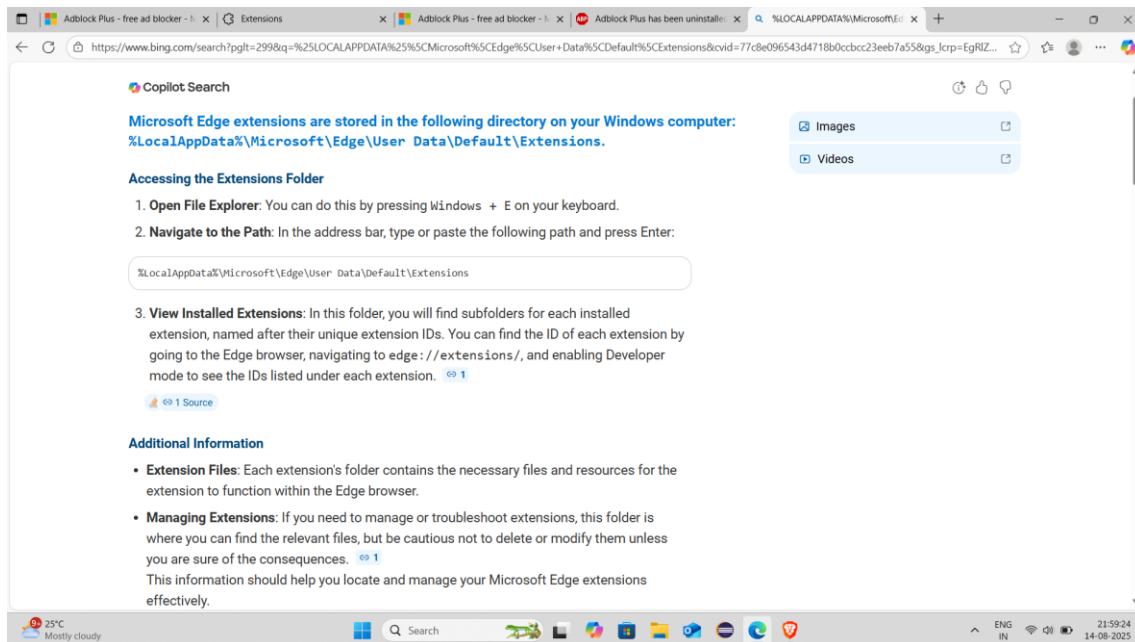


- Ask: *Do I still need this?* If not, plan to remove it.
- Check performance impact:
 - **Chrome/Edge/Brave:** press **Shift+Esc** for the browser **Task Manager** and sort by CPU/memory; heavy or constantly active extensions stand out.
 - **Firefox:** type `about:performance`.

5) Disable or remove



- Prefer **Remove/Delete** for anything unused or suspicious.
- If unsure, **Disable** first, browse for a few minutes, and see if issues disappear—then **Remove**.



- Remove only what **you** installed. If an extension says “**Installed by enterprise policy**”, don’t force it off—contact your IT admin.

6) Restart and verify improvements

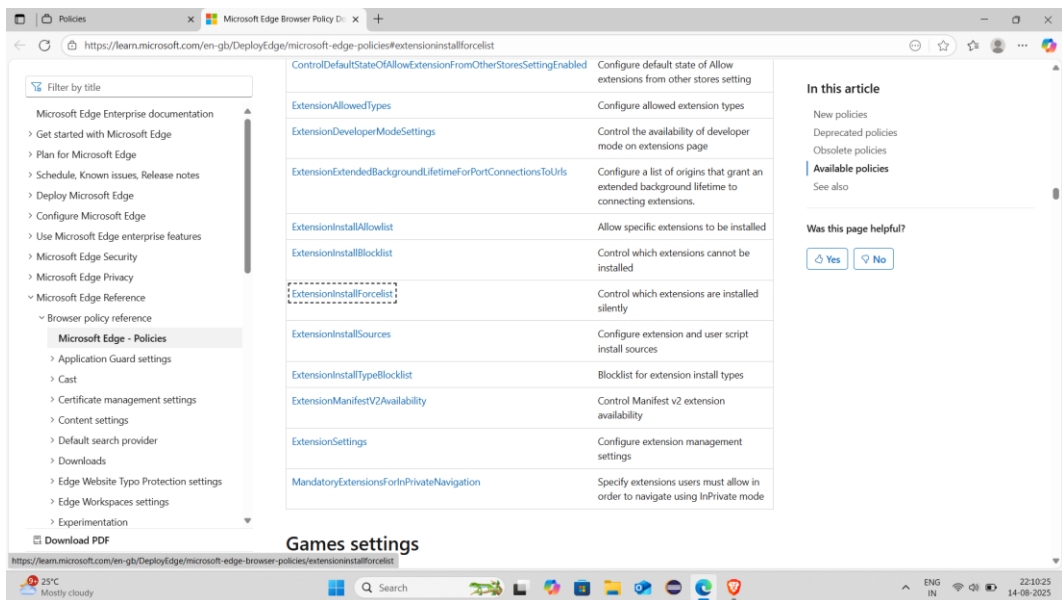
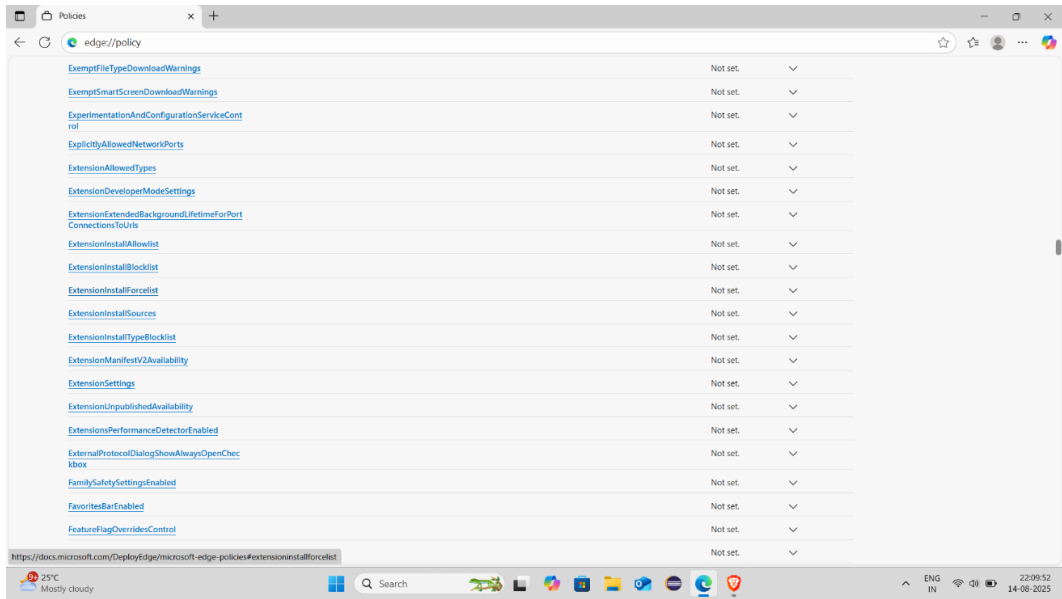
- Re-check performance (**Shift+Esc** / `about:performance`).
- Confirm **homepage**, **default search**, and **new tab** weren’t changed.
 - If they were, **reset settings**:
 - **Chrome/Brave**: Settings → Reset settings → **Restore settings to their original defaults**
 - **Edge**: Settings → Reset settings → **Restore settings to their default values**
 - **Firefox**: Help → **Troubleshoot Mode** or **Refresh Firefox**

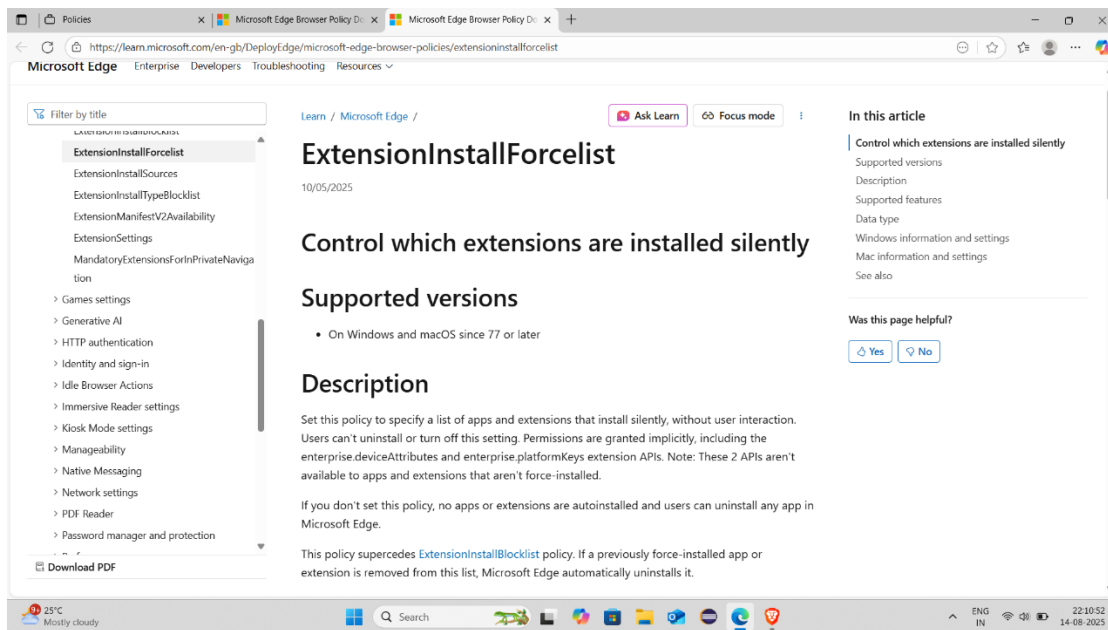
7) Research: how malicious extensions harm users

- **Data theft**: read/modify page content; capture form inputs/keystrokes; scrape cookies/session tokens.
- **Ad/redirect injection**: replace links, insert ads, hijack search queries.
- **Tracking/profiling** across sites via broad host permissions.
- **Download manipulation or clipboard hijacking** (e.g., crypto addresses).
- **Native messaging abuses**: if paired with a local helper app, may access files/OS features.

(Advanced check in Chrome/Edge)

- Go to `chrome://policy` / `edge://policy` and look for **ExtensionInstallForcelist**. If present, those are **managed**; don’t remove—report to IT if suspicious.





8) Document what you did (simple template)

Use this log for each device/browser profile:

- **Date/Time:**
- **Device & Browser (Version):**
- **Profile/Account** (if multiple):
- **Before:** Number of extensions enabled/disabled.
- **Reviewed Extensions** (repeat per extension):
 - Name | **ID** | Version | Source (Web Store/AMO/Other)
 - Permissions/Site Access:
 - Status: **Kept/Disabled/Removed**
 - Reason/Notes (evidence, odd behavior, review link):
- **After:** Extensions enabled/disabled; performance notes (Task Manager snapshot).
- **Follow-up:** Recheck in 30 days; keep only essentials; lock down to **“On click”** where possible.